

Mock Interview

TIP101

Agenda

1 Welcome 🙌

2 Mock Interview

3 **BREAK**

4 Collaborative Problem Solving

5 Wrap Up

10 minutes

35 minutes

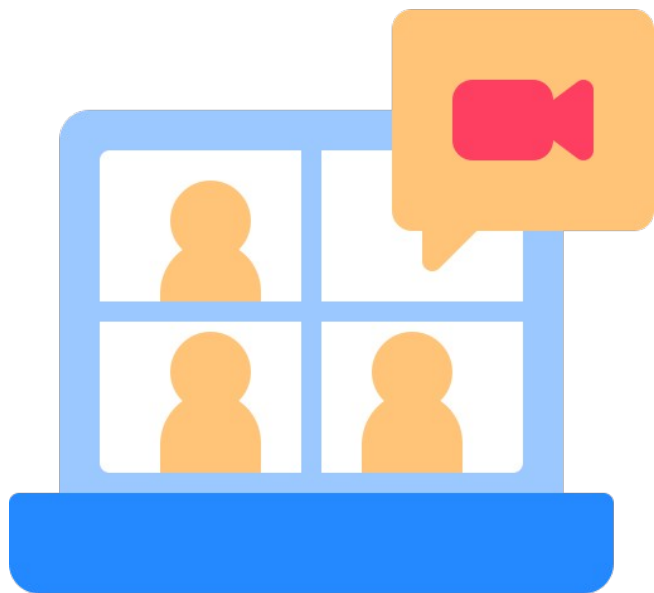
5 minutes

60 minutes

10 minutes

10 minutes

Welcome! 🖐️



**Turn on your
cameras**



**Fill out the entry
ticket**



Icebreaker

5 minutes

Question:

We should always prioritize our health, but sometimes we still get sick! What are your go-to meals or snacks for when you aren't feeling well?

Answer:

Share your answer in the Zoom chat below. What kinds of pets do you have if any? If you don't have any, share what type you would like to have, if any.

Your Feedback



Glows

- + Many TF shoutouts for helping breakout rooms go smoothly!
- + Students commenting that linked lists feel more manageable.



Grows

- Students want more visual components for certain topics.
- Higher amount of technical issues.



Announcements & Volunteer Signup (x1)

- * Our first 🔥 **Fireside Chat** today! The topic is:
 - “How to use Leadership Principles during the interview”
- * **Live Mock Interview** demonstration today 👤💼
 - We will need **one student volunteer** to work through 1 problem each (more info on the next slides!)
 - Students must be camera ready and able to share their screen while solving the problem on VS Code.
 - The emphasis will be practicing the **UMPIRE** strategy.
 - Topic: **linked lists**.

35 minutes

Mock Interview

Today's Mock Interview

- * I will be the interviewer.
 - As the interviewer, I will simulate a realistic technical interview by asking probing questions and providing minimal hints when necessary.
- * A volunteer student will be the interviewee.
 - As the interviewee, you will think aloud while solving the problem, applying UMPIRE.
- * The rest of the class will observe.

Mock Interview Process

1. **Quick intro** (name, school, major)
2. Interviewer **introduces the problem**
3. Candidate **opens link** to problem and **shares screen**
4. Candidate works through the **UPI steps** with interviewer
 - If you need to look something up, it's ok to Google it.
 - Say what you're thinking, what you're doing, and why.
 - Pay attention to feedback and hints from interviewer.
5. After: **Celebrate and recap** what went well!

If you are not the candidate. . .

- * Hold all comments (on mic or in chat) until the end
- * Imagine what you would do in the candidate's shoes
- * Write down and be ready to share:
 - 1 thing the candidate did that you will start doing too!
 - 1 thing you'll do differently now that you've seen this interview.

Evaluation Criteria

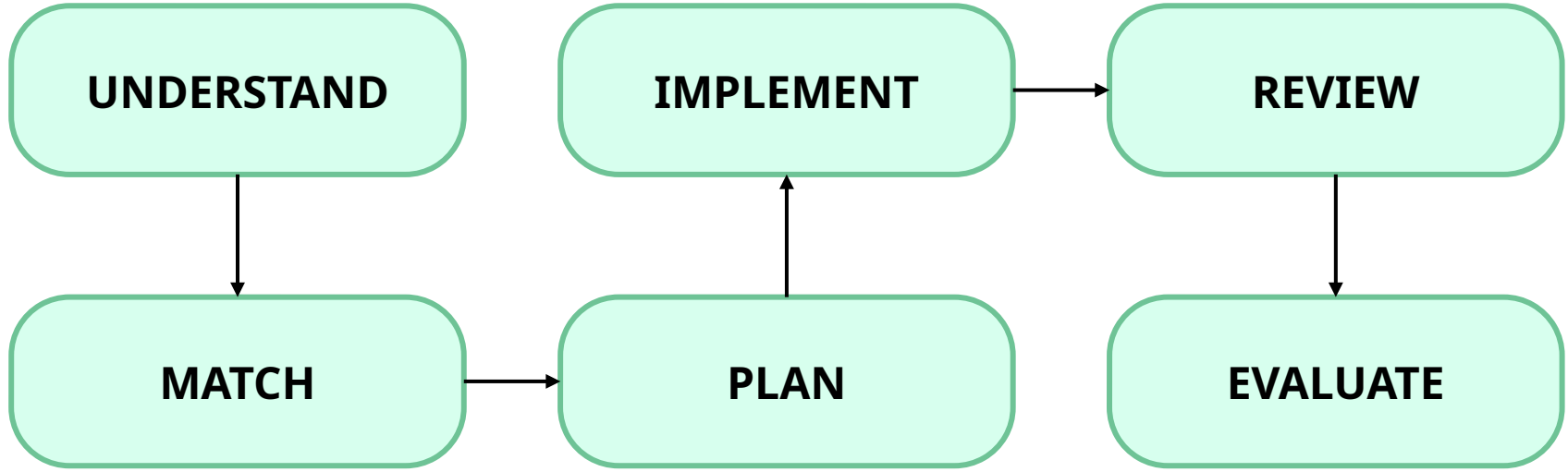
Key Areas of Focus

- * Clarity
- * Problem-solving process
- * Use of the UMPIRE framework

Reminders

- * Prioritize readability and logical flow over rushing to a solution.
- * Communicate effectively throughout to simulate a real-world technical interview scenario.

UMPIRE



Problem

You are given the heads of two sorted linked lists **list1** and **list2**.

Merge the two lists into one **sorted** list. The list should be made by splicing together the nodes of the first two lists.

Return *the head of the merged linked list*.

[Full problem description](#)



Discussion

3 minutes

In the chat . . .

What was one thing the candidate did
that you will start doing too?

What is one thing you'll do differently now
that you've seen this interview?



Break Time!

Take 5 mins to step away from the computer. Feel free to turn off your camera and return promptly after 5 mins.



60 minutes

Collaborative Problem Solving



Breakout Rooms

60 minutes

1. 🏃 Navigate to your breakout room.
2. 🙌 Introduce yourselves!
3. 🧑💻 Work on the problems for your selected unit.

10 minutes

Wrap Up



One Good Thing

Let's reflect on today's session. Maybe you got a question answered, overcame a specific coding challenge, or learned how to do something completely new!

In the chat, share at least one good thing you've learned or experienced during the session today.

Let's celebrate together!



Session Survey Time!





Final Reminders

- ☐ Finish the problem sets for additional practice
- ☐ Take the weekly HackerRank assessment by Sunday @ midnight
- ☐ Visit a **Study Hall Session** to deepen your understanding, work through challenges, and connect with course material alongside your peers!



Fireside Chat: Behavioral Interviews

- ☐ Behavioral interviews are to assess how well you work with others, and to learn if you have displayed “**superpowers**” that the company emphasizes.
- ☐ Use the S.T.A.R. method when answering behavioral questions.
 - **Situation, Task, Action, and Result.** Give context on the story and how you were able to accomplish something difficult.
- ☐ Be aware of what companies are looking for. If it is a major company, the chances are high that you can find their “**Leadership Principles**” online.
 - These make up the rubric of how you are assessed during the interview.



Fireside Chat: Behavioral Interviews

- ☐ The questions are super vague to leave it all up to you to guide the response.
- ☐ These are typically not about the technical details of projects or roles.
- ☐ Example S.T.A.R. Questions:
 - “Tell me about a time during a previous job/project when you overcame a disagreement with a teammate.”
 - “Share a bit about a time where you had to manage multiple priorities; how did you decide what was most important?”
 - “How would you handle an unexpected delay in a project?”



Fireside Chat: Behavioral Interviews

- ❑ Be aware of what the interviewer's experience is like. They don't just rate you 0-100%. They have strict rubrics which are defined by their companies core principles.
- ❑ While it might seem difficult to "reorient" your responses for a given company, you will discover that many of these principles overlap.
- ❑ The goal is not to showcase every single principle (that's hard to do with just a couple of questions!), but to try and identify which ones are best for a person of your level. For example:
 - **New Grad:** Resourceful, resilient, self-driven, learns on the fly, etc.
 - **Senior Engineer:** Optimizes processes, mentors others, designs large systems.
 - **All levels:** Good communicator, trustworthy, collaborative, etc.



Fireside Chat: Behavioral Interviews

- If we look at the overlaps, we see they are really just looking for general attributes, not a perfect candidate.

- General Attribute: **Move Fast**
 - Amazon (Bias for Action), Google (Fast is better than slow), Microsoft (Culture in action)

- General Attribute: **Always put the customer first**
 - Amazon (Customer Obsession), Microsoft (Customer Obsession), Google (Focus on the Customer)

- General Attribute: **Candidate shows continued self-driven learning**
 - Amazon (Learn and be curious), Microsoft (Growth Mindset), Google (Great isn't good enough)